Company policies

1. **Read a story from Dana where she describes her new company. Which benefits does her company offer? Tick in the table below.**

"Hi, Kate.
So today was my first day at my new company. Let me share some insights I have.
So I don't have to come to the office and spend time commuting every day. We have an English teacher onboard and employees can attend free English lessons. But the most exciting thing for me is, that my company covers my dental bills. I am so happy I joined them.
Also, I don't have to start work at 9, I can start whenever I want but I have to finish all of my tasks by the end of the working day. Also, I have received, 500$ just for joining this company, can you imagine that? I am so excited!!!"

Company car	☐
Sign-on bonus	☐
Dental plan	☐
Flexible hours	☐
Yoga classes	☐
Learning programs	☐
Remote work	☐
Free meals in the office	☐

What benefits from the table would be the most desirable for you?

Do you have any of the mentioned benefits in your company?

2. Read the "We offer" section of a job post. Answer the questions below.

- **We don't require your presence in the office, you can work from anywhere.**
- **20 days' annual leave, and unlimited sick days with medical proof.**
- **Private health insurance.**
- **Learning and development budget.**
- **Corporate presents for your birthday and Christmas.**
- **Bonus for a good performance.**
- **Gym Reimbursement.**

1) What benefits does this company offer?
2) How many days of vacation can you have?
3) Would you like to have perks like these?

3. Read Jake's career history. Put the events in his career in the correct order.

Part 1.

	Before finishing the Frontend course Jake **applied for** jobs in 15 companies.
	Digital Solutions **offered** Jake **a position as** a Frontend trainee.
	His first interview was successful and he **was short-listed** for a technical interview.
	In a year he was **promoted to** a Junior Frontend position.
	2 years later his project closed and he **was made redundant.**
	He was invited for an **interview** at Digital Solutions.
	2 weeks later he got a call from a recruiter and was **phone screened.**

Part 2.

	He worked with Web World for 5 years but at some point, he felt like he started to burn out so Jake decided to take a **sabbatical.**
	He **applied for** a Fullstack position at Web World company.
	His blog was a huge success so Jake decided to create a website for travellers.
	While he was **unemployed** Jake studied Python.
	During a sabbatical, Jake travelled to Asia and wrote a travel blog.
	He was hired by Web World and relocated to London where they had their main office.
	He started his own product company called “Travel with me”. Now he hires new people to join his team.

4. Complete the sentences with missing words, and use the correct tense.

to apply
to offer
to study
to short-list (someone)
to promote
to relocate
to phone screen

1. Before finishing the Frontend course Jake _____ for jobs in 15 companies.
2. Digital Solutions _____ Jake a position as a Frontend trainee.
3. His first interview was successful and he was ____ for a technical interview.
4. In a year he was _____ to a Junior Frontend position.
5. 2 weeks later he got a call from a recruiter and was_____.
6. While he was unemployed Jake _____Python.
7. He was hired by Web World and _____to London where they had their main office.

Tell your career story by using words and expressions from exercise 4.

5. Match the word with the definition.

1. Aptitude	a) Knowledge that you need to be able to do smth
2. Background	b) Information that someone knows
3. Experience	c) an ability to do smth well, especially because you have practised it
4. Know-how	d) knowledge or skill that you have from being in different situations
5. Knowledge	e) the type of education, experience and family that you have
6. Skill	f) a natural ability to do smth well or to learn it quickly

Write what skills, experience and aptitude you have

ex. I have an **aptitude for** foreign languages
I have **experience with**
I have a technical background

6. Make nouns from the adjectives and verbs below.

ex. "Strong-strength"

1. Strong -
2. Weak -
3. Responsible -
4. Perform -
5. Commit -
6. Achieve -

Use nouns you've made to complete the sentences. Use the plural form if needed.

1. What are your main functions and duties in your present job?
What are your .....?
2. How does the company know you are doing a good job? How do they measure your.....?
3. What are the positive things you can bring to the team? What are your.....?
4. And what would you say are your.....? Come on, be honest now
5. What is the one thing you are most proud of in your present job? What is your greatest .....?
6. If we offer you this job, what kind of .....will you have to the company? Will you be looking for another job after a year or two?

Now please answer Qs 1, 3, 4, 5.

7. Watch the video. Which company offers the coolest benefits?

AOL, Yahoo! + More of the Best Companies with the Coolest Perks...

Watch the video for the second time and tick the benefits you hear.

- ☐ **Dental service**
- ☐ **Car wash**
- ☐ **TGIF**
- ☐ **Kids Center**
- ☐ **Thai Tuesday**
- ☐ **Pool tournament**
- ☐ **lip sync battle**
- ☐ **free beer**
- ☐ **Yoga classes**
- ☐ **Hair salon in the office**
- ☐ **Farmers market**
- ☐ **Dry cleaning**

Are these benefits motivating?
Which benefits in your opinion are not useful?
If you had to choose 3 benefits from the video, what would they be?

8. ADDITIONAL TASK!!!!

Read the text about cool benefit ideas and answer the questions below

1: Hubspot – Rooftop Meetings

Hubspot started out as a small company in their CEO's house. He had a small rooftop terrace where the team often gathered for beers after work, and this tradition continues today. Brian, the CEO, believes that these meetings led to the company's success. They bonded the team together and made work a more sociable place to be. Any office can replicate this – you don't need a fancy terrace – just having a place for the team to relax and kick back will make for a close-knit company culture.

2: LinkedIn – Walk & Talk

LinkedIn introduced walk & talks where team members can take a stroll to catch up or have meetings. It's a great way to introduce some exercise into the work day and it releases a whole load of **fun-inducing endorphins**, (ahem, fundorphins anyone?). These endorphins reduce stress, improve health and make people happier!

3: The BBC – Personalise your Work Space

The BBC offers its employees £250 to personalise their workspace with anything from a potted peace lily to a collection of mint-in-box Star Wars figurines. Of course, you don't need to offer team members money, just give them free reign to decorate their space as they choose. This **helps employees feel more at ease**, besides, who knows where it might lead?

4: Google – Free Food

Google gets people, and people like food. Especially when it's free! So, Google provides food for its team – which leads to great company culture. Not many companies can pay three meals per day for each employee – but the odd lunch here and there is a small gesture that speaks volumes. It makes employees feel valued, besides, you can always rely on food for a fantastic time.

5: Apple – United by a Common Goal

At Apple, people understand what they are doing. They also understand how they contribute to the company. In short – the place is oozing with **epic meaning**. People all want to be involved with something bigger than themselves – and Apple make sure that their team understands why they are doing what they do.

6: Intuit – Work Life Balance

This software company doesn't expect employees to arrive before nine, or stay after five thirty. This helps maintain a healthy work-life balance and makes the time spent at work more enjoyable. Perhaps surprisingly, research suggests that companies who go out of their way to encourage a healthy work-life balance benefit from **increased profits and productivity**!

7: Growth Engineering – Monthly Challenges

Here at GE we craft our own ways to make work more fun. One of our favourite things is the GE monthly challenge. Our idea is simple, we set a new challenge at the beginning of each month. These challenges can be anything, be it a bake-off or a one-legged race. If you do this, keep a record of the scores and watch the tournament blossom.

1. **Which company:**

- provides free food to its employees?
- Does not focus on hours but on actual work done?
- Gives money so their employees can spend them on working space decoration?

Has rooftop parties?

2. Choose 3 ideas from the text that you would use at your company?

3. Think of any other 3 benefits or ideas that could make work fun.